

THE ART OF WRITING A RECOUNT: RETELLING PAST EVENTS

ORIENTATION (Setting the Scene)

INTRODUCES:
Who? Where? When? What? Why?

EXAMPLE:

Last summer (When),
my family and I (Who)
went to a sunny
beach (Where) for a
holiday (What & Why).

SEQUENCE OF EVENTS (What Happened)

RETELL IN CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER:
First, Then, Next, After that, Finally.



REORIENTATION / CONCLUSION (Wrapping Up)

CONCLUDES:
Final thoughts, feelings, or opinions.

EXAMPLE:
It was the best day
ever! I felt so
happy and tired.

KEY LANGUAGE FEATURES

- **PAST TENSE VERBS** (e.g., went, saw, played)
- **FIRST** (I, we) or **THIRD PERSON** (He, she, they)
- **TIME CONNECTIVES** (e.g., yesterday, later, meanwhile)
- **SPECIFIC NOUNS** (e.g., My dog, Rover)
- **DESCRIPTIVE LANGUAGE** (Adjectives & Adverbs)

TYPES OF RECOUNTS

- **PERSONAL** (Diary, Letter)
- **FACTUAL** (News Report, Biography)
- **IMAGINATIVE** (Fictional Story based on facts)
- **PROCEDURAL** (Science Experiment Report)

PURPOSE: TO INFORM OR ENTERTAIN BY RETELLING PAST EXPERIENCES.



Retell Writing Structure



How to retell a story clearly

1.



1. Title

Choose a title that tells what story you are retelling.

What is the story called?



2.



2. Orientation / Beginning

Introduce the characters, setting, and what the story is about at the start.

Who? Where? When?



3.



3. Events in Order

Retell the main events in the order they happened. Use sequencing words to help.

What happened first, next, then, and finally?



4.



4. Important Details

Include the key details, feelings, and actions that help the reader understand the story.

Which details matter most?



5.



5. Ending

Finish by telling how the story ends and wrap up the retell neatly.

How does the story end?



Retell Writing Tips



Use sequencing words



Stick to the main events



Retell in the correct order



Include important details



Use your own words



Check your sentences and punctuation

